

**film review**

**Little Boy Lost**

**RAMCHAND PAKISTANI**

Rating: ★★★★★

Director: Mehreen Jabbar

Starring: Nandita Das, Rashid Farooqui

I understand that Pakistan loves Bollywood movies but must every Indian depicted in that nation's movies speak in Mumbaiya slang and watch Sridevi films? Such caricatures irritate in what could have been a thoroughly moving tale of a family divided by the India-Pakistan border, as out of place in Pakistan because they are Hindus, as in India because they are Dalits. Snarling BSF guards, inhuman conditions in Indian jails, stomach churning torture of Pakistani prisoners. First-time director Mehreen Jabbar tries hard to stay politically correct in a film where neither Indians nor



**POLITICALLY CORRECT:** Das (centre) and Farooqui (right)

Pakistanis come out looking good. So Hindu temples are shown in a state of ruin in the Pakistani village while in the Bhuj prison, the movie lingers, albeit almost comically, on a high caste jail official refusing to touch Ramchand, the seven-year-old Dalit boy who is at the heart of the story. The movie is at its best, like Santosh

Sivan's uneven *Tahaan*, when it dwells on the young Ramchand's face, as he first traps and then kills an insect in his matchbox, or eyes his father's pen longingly. And I challenge even the most hard-hearted of viewers not to bawl when a more grown up Ramchand is sent back to Pakistan while his father has to stay behind.

**by Kaveree Bamzai**

**arts**

**A Varied Palette**



**DELHI** The Religare Arts Initiative has opened its new gallery with

a group show titled Outer Circle. The participating artistes include Akshay Rathore, Anant Mishra, Prashast Kachru, Sumakshi Singh and Preeti Hooda. The exhibition will be on till October 30. Added to the gallery is a café and an art library. Also, the Dhoomimal Gallery is celebrating 17 successful years of Ravi Jain Memorial Foundation with an exhibition of paintings of old, contemporary as well as upcoming artistes. The line-up includes, F. N. Souza, J. Swaminathan, Sridhar Iyer, Subhachan Yadav and Umesh Sharma. Be there to catch the past, present and the future. On till October 10.

**festival**

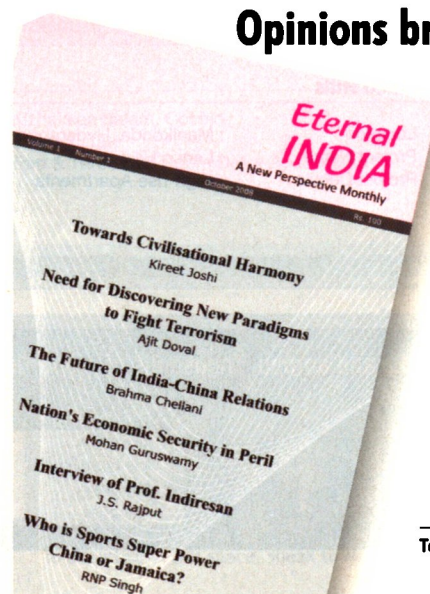
**Musical Revelry**

**JODHPUR** The notes of the Rajasthan International Music Festival are all set to echo in the Mehrangarh Fort. October 10 will see Parveen and Rehana Mirza perform songs in the kohta tradition followed by Shubha Mudgal's interpretation of the maand. The next day, tune into qawwalis by Zakir and Zaki Ali. A jugalbundi between Manipuri musician Guru Rueben Mashangwa and USA's Phoebe Legre will follow. On the third day, Ustad Sultan Khan and Lakhon Khan Manganiar will perform together. It also features a music synthesis between folk artistes of Rajasthan and jazz group Yuri Honing Trio. The finale will be a recital by folk music maestro, Prahlad Tipaniya and his ensemble. On till October 14.

**by S. Sahaya Ranjit**

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